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Top Skills

Technology Standards

Program Development

Narrative Intelligence

Languages

English

Certifications

The Data Scientist's Toolbox

Quantitative Methods

Journalism, the future, and you!

Data Science @Cisco Generative AI
Green Belt 2024

Tim Shores

I make organizations and systems work more effectively
Leverett, Massachusetts, United States

Summary

I make organizations and systems work more effectively. Here's how: most useful knowledge is stuck — in people's heads, social systems, team silos, processes nobody interrogates, or data waiting to be shaped into a decision. I find it and work with people to restructure how the organization stores and represents it, making that knowledge useful. The goal is always to support people in making and measuring better decisions. At Cisco, that meant leading content strategy and information architecture for security products, treating technical content as a problem of business systems and team alignment, not a pile of deliverables. I served on a cross-organizational tiger team transforming Cisco's technical communications into an AI-native content system, collaborating on content modeling and context engineering that structured institutional knowledge for accurate, efficient delivery by generative AI products. This built on earlier work documenting Cisco's LLM-powered assistant and prototyping AI generation of identity-based technical content. Before Cisco, I built databases of European Parliament voting patterns for multistakeholder forest policy campaigns, designed donor data systems for a rapidly growing Haiti-focused nonprofit, constructed the knowledge base that cut support call volume by 20% at a software company, and wound down an unprofitable service line at an IT business. In civil society, I lead data and operations on the board of The 'MPOWER Project, and serve on a planning board, an energy committee, and two school committees in Western Massachusetts. Nonprofit capacity, municipal budgeting, policy analysis, performance evaluation, and community needs assessments all drill down to trapped knowledge, and the value is making it legible to the people responsible for decisions and communicating to the public. How do I do it? I walk around and talk to people. Sometimes I get lucky enough to help a group rope a grant, and my walking and talking becomes facilitated group work with mixed-methods research, followed by a dense but charming report and rounds of public interest communications. My wide range of work is deliberate. Organizations get stuck in knowledge

tarpits — knowledge trapped in silos, legacies of practice, in-group dynamics that hush some voices, complexity outrunning management structures, decisions starved of information that already exists somewhere in the building. The whiteboard-and-dialogue work of getting unstuck transfers across domains. The trick is getting the group to trust the process enough to try something new.

Experience

The 'MPOWER Project

7 months

Board Member | Data & Tech Lead

January 2026 - Present (7 months)

New York, NY

The 'MPOWER Project is a New York-based 501(c)(3) influence and innovation lab that counters harmful ideologies and strengthens civic resilience through narrative research, strategic advisory, and community-based programming.

As Board Member and Data & Tech Lead, I build the data and technology infrastructure that makes the organization's research and relationships usable — knowledge systems, network analysis, and communications tooling — and contribute to grant writing, communications, program and partner development, and governance.

InterNational Committee for Information Technology Standards/AI Working Group (INCITS)

May 2026 - Present (3 months)

Org Member (Representative)

Cisco

4 years 6 months

Technical Education Content Developer

May 2024 - July 2026 (2 years 3 months)

Content strategy lead for Cisco Secure Access, working in close collaboration with product, engineering, UX, and CX teams. Architected end-to-end content strategy for Secure Access, launched a new documentation set for SASE Management, and drove quality and accuracy improvements to IPsec tunnels

documentation. Domain range spans SSE/SASE, IPsec tunneling, SSO, and AI assistant integration with SaaS products.

Member of the Content Modeling workstream on Cisco's AI-Native Content Strategy initiative — a cross-organizational tiger team restructuring Cisco's entire documentation corpus, past and future, into a graphRAG-structured, AI-native content system. Delivered hands-on content modeling and context engineering work for a PRD, designing structures that enable AI reasoning and dynamic, persona-driven content experiences. The broader initiative spans AI-assisted authoring, intent-driven content retrieval and governance, and continuous quality improvement.

Developing information architecture expertise as a formal IA mentee and applying it to AI-ready content structures across the Secure Access product line. Led collaborative context engineering work supporting AI tooling adoption and culture change across technical communications, including enterprise CMS metadata and content/data analysis for migration prep. Earlier work includes researching and writing documentation for the Cisco Assistant LLM feature and co-developing a hackathon proof-of-concept for LLM-generated, identity-based technical content.

Technical Communications Specialist

February 2022 - May 2024 (2 years 4 months)

Customer communications lead and content researcher for Cisco Duo on the Security Documentation team. Planned and wrote communications connecting cybersecurity product customers with what they needed to know about product changes, vulnerabilities, and required actions. Wrote release notes each sprint and coordinated customer communication impact studies with Product and Data Science teams.

Worked to extend the Duo communications model to other Cisco Security products. Facilitated discussions with SMEs across design, engineering, and product management, and contributed to content performance analysis and process improvement for the team's publishing operations.

Mentored early-career coworkers and students.

Town Common Research

Community Based Participatory Researcher

January 2022 - August 2023 (1 year 8 months)

Leverett, MA

Community-based participatory research for towns and community organizations in Western Massachusetts. Collected and reported data for Age-Friendly needs assessments and supported equity and justice initiatives, helping local organizers build evidence-based knowledge for community-driven decision-making.

Partnership for Policy Integrity

Forest Policy Campaign Researcher

October 2019 - January 2023 (3 years 4 months)

Working to defend forests.

Researched and wrote in support of the Forest Defenders Alliance campaign to remove forest biomass from the European Union Renewable Energy Directive and end the counting of wood burning toward emissions reduction targets. Managed the campaign website and participated in outreach.

Built and supported a Google Data Studio database and UI to support campaigners tracking European Parliament communications, parliamentary committee actions, and voting patterns on forests and environmental policy, supporting campaign monitoring and targeted outreach.

forestdefenders.eu

Hope for Haiti

Director of Data & Donor Experience

August 2019 - February 2022 (2 years 7 months)

Leverett, MA

Managed revenue data, grant writing, grant pipeline, and donor services for a nonprofit working to improve quality of life for the Haitian people, particularly children. Streamlined donation processing by replacing manual workflows with Python scripts, reducing processing time and data entry errors. Designed program concepts for Haitian farmer support initiatives and wrote funding proposals to sustain them. Helped coordinate galas and fundraising events.

Led fundraising response through an extraordinary sequence of crises: COVID-19, civil unrest, the assassination of President Moïse, and the August 2021 earthquake.

VentureWell

Platform Analyst

November 2016 - August 2019 (2 years 10 months)

Hadley, MA

Salesforce platform lead for a nonprofit cultivating early-stage STEM ventures. First responder for development planning and implementation, second-tier resource for user support and training. Designed and built solutions supporting grants management, impact evaluation, program monitoring, digital marketing, and relationship management across funders, investors, and program participants.

Worked across Salesforce Community, Pardot, Service Cloud, Process Builder and Flow, Apex, Lightning Web Components, and Nonprofit Success Pack, integrated with NetSuite via SOAP API and supported by tools including Form Assembly, Conga Composer, and RStudio.

Not1More

Program Lead, Tech, Innovation, & Coalition Development

August 2015 - August 2019 (4 years 1 month)

Leverett, MA

Technology and coalition development for a global environmental justice organization supporting frontline forest defenders facing violence and reprisals.

Designed and deployed technology solutions for researchers and defenders in remote forest sites, including Forest Threat Sensor (peer-to-peer alerting and mapping for defenders encountering risk), TIRTL (rights violation documentation and reporting), and DefenderDirect (direct giving fundraising). Managed CRM development, data collection design, web development, and digital marketing.

Built coalition relationships and wrote for fundraising and advocacy. Supported the Forest Defenders Conference, the "I am Chut Wutty" documentary campaign, the Bloodwood report on unauthorized rosewood plunder in Guinea-Bissau, and the Amazon Security Framework community of practice for defenders under threat in the Amazon.

Computer Courage

IT Services Manager

January 2013 - November 2014 (1 year 11 months)

Berkeley, CA

Led a team of 5 to 7 technicians serving 150 small business customers at a Berkeley IT service provider and web developer. Personally closed 30 contracts through business goal analysis, clear proposals, and reliable service.

Collaborated with the President on business operations improvements including WordPress CRM implementation, project management templates, cost forecasting, service outcome evaluation, and KPI monitoring.

DOMICO Software

Production Manager and Senior Database Specialist

June 2006 - January 2013 (6 years 8 months)

Oakland, CA

Database software company specializing in the self-storage real estate subsector. Worked on a small team supporting finance and management clients through data migrations, software customization, QA, and feature development on SQL Server.

Reduced support call volume 20% and improved resolution time 40% by mentoring technicians, constructing and managing a knowledge base, and driving process improvement and automation for QA and ETL workflows.

Borders Group Inc

Helpdesk Technician

January 1999 - September 2000 (1 year 9 months)

Ann Arbor, MI

Remote support for Windows NT and OS/2 systems across Borders and Waldenbooks stores, connected by VSAT. Supported email, inventory, and point-of-sale applications.

Education

University of Michigan

BGS, Linguistics, Philosophy, and Psychology · (September 1998 - June 2004)

University of Massachusetts Amherst

Graduate Certificate, Data Analytics and Computational Social Science (DACSS) · (November 2022 - December 2024)